The Moon · Tier Pack · Aspire

Learning goal: I can explain how the Moon orbits the Earth and why we see different Moon phases.

Aspire Route (Book First)

Explain why Earth's shadow does not cause monthly Moon phases, and why we do not get a lunar eclipse at every Full Moon.

Help: Monthly phases come from viewing the Moon's own __ side. We do not get an eclipse every Full Moon because the Moon's orbit is __ by about 5 degrees.

Optional Make It · Aspire

Make an Eclipse vs Phase Comparison Card

Draw a 2-box diagram contrasting why monthly Full Moons happen every 28 days (tilted orbit) whereas lunar eclipses happen only when the Moon crosses Earth's shadow line.

Word Help

natural satellite: a body in space, like the Moon, that orbits a planet

reflect: when light from the Sun bounces off the surface of the Moon

phases of the Moon: the changing shapes of the sunlit part of the Moon as seen from Earth

waxing and waning: waxing means the lit part we see is growing; waning means it is shrinking

Exit Check

How many days does the Moon take to orbit the Earth once?

Where does the light we see from the Moon come from?

Explain why we see a Full Moon when the Moon is on the opposite side of Earth from the Sun.